There are many types of consumers and we can classify them into specific groups depending on the food that they consume. These are:

- **herbivores**

Animals which eat plants or plant products e.g: cattle, deer, goat and rat.

- **carnivores**

Animals that eat other animals e.g: Lion, tiger, frog and owl.

- **omnivores**

Animals that eat both plants and animals e.g: Humans, dog and crow

- **decomposers**

Micro-organisms that obtain energy from the chemical breakdown of dead organisms (both plants and animals). They break complex organic substances into simple organic substances that goes into the soil and are used by plants. (e.g) Bacterium, Fungi

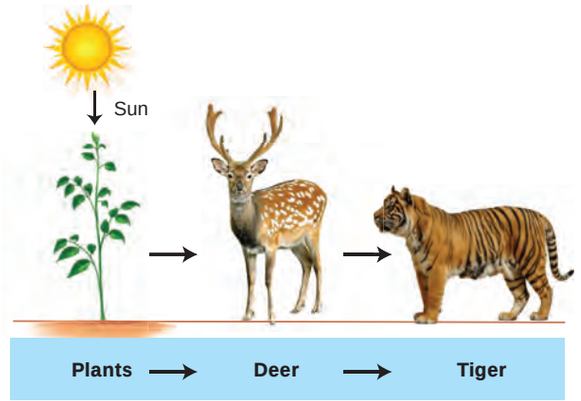
Food chain

In a forest, deer eats grass, and in turn tiger eats deers. In any ecosystem there is a chain like relationship between the organisms that live there. **The sequence of who eats whom in an ecosystem is called as food chain.**

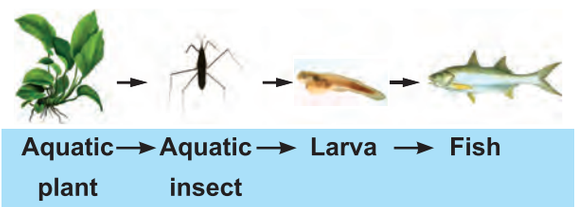
It describes how an organism gets food and nutrients by eating other organisms.

A food chain shows the relationship between producers (e.g. grass), consumers (e.g. deer, goat, cow and tiger) and decomposer (Bacteria and Fungi)

E.g. Food chain in a terrestrial (Grassland) ecosystem



E.g. Food chain in an aquatic (Lake) ecosystem



Energy flow

The food chain begins with the energy given by the Sun. Sunlight triggers photosynthesis in plants. The energy from the Sun is stored in the plant parts. When the grasshopper eats the grass, the energy flows from grass to grasshopper. Frog gets energy by eating grasshopper. This energy is transferred to a crow, when the frog is eaten by a crow. Thus we conclude the primary energy production in the world of living things is produced by plants, that is by photosynthesis.

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